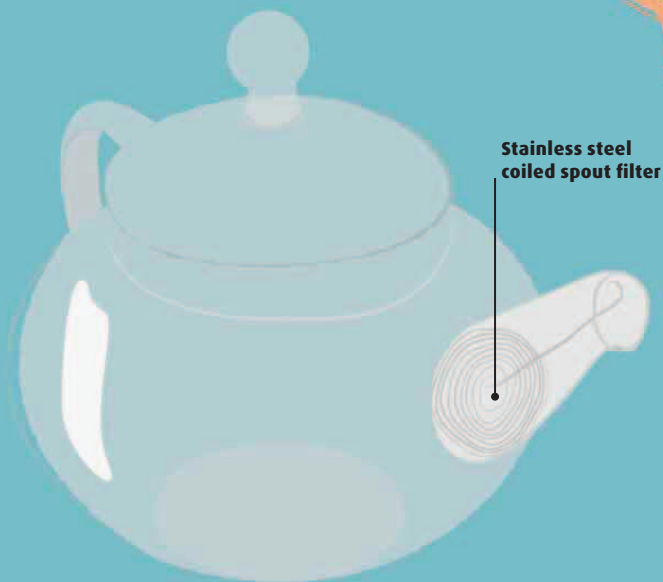
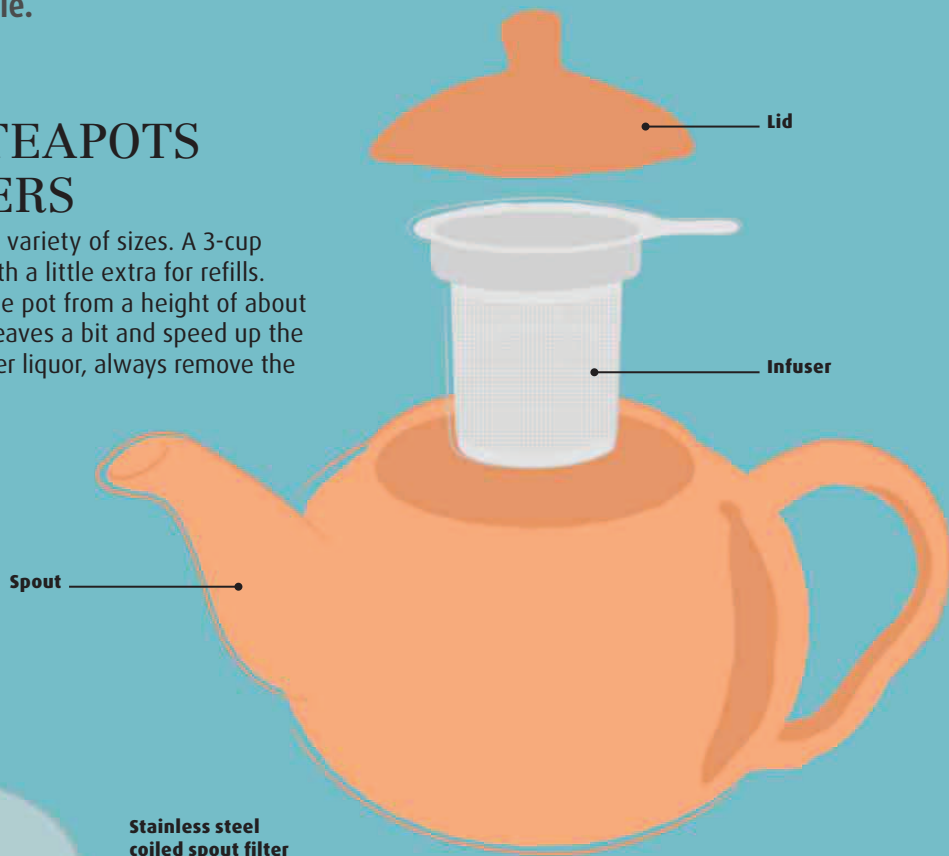


TEA-MAKING EQUIPMENT

Tea shops offer a baffling array of teaware designed for a superlative tea experience. Assuming that the tea will be prepared using loose leaves, and that they need room to expand, here are some of the best choices that are available.

PORCELAIN TEAPOTS WITH INFUSERS

The classic teapot comes in a variety of sizes. A 3-cup pot will serve two people with a little extra for refills. Pouring the hot water into the pot from a height of about 10in (25cm) will “push” the leaves a bit and speed up the flavor release. To avoid a bitter liquor, always remove the infuser once the tea is ready.



GLASS TEAPOT WITH COILED SPOUT FILTER

A glass teapot has all the conveniences of other infuser teapots and the added benefit of enabling you to watch the leaves swirl through the water, releasing their colors. The stainless steel coiled spout filter stops the leaves escaping from the teapot as the liquid is poured into the cup.